Righteous Movements and Government: The Global War on Terrorism

Sermon for Shabbat and Sunday
Readings drawn from the Institute for Scripture Research (ISR) Scriptures

To the Fleet and Command Staff,
As government officers, we do not have the luxury of choosing our wars based on convenience. We are mandatory service members in the Global War on Terrorism (GWOT). However, the general population has fundamentally misunderstood what this war actually entails. They have allowed media, prejudice, and political narratives to define the enemy.

We do not operate on narratives. We operate on the law. And as Vanguard officers, we must follow the operational definitions set by our government. The Scriptures are explicit regarding our chain of command in this matter: *"Let everyone be subject to the governing authorities, for there is no authority except that which God has established... For the one in authority is God's servant for your good. But if you do wrong, be afraid, for rulers do not bear the sword for no reason."* **(Romans 13:1-4)**

Therefore, we will define the enemy exactly as the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) defines it, and we will execute a Righteous Movement to eliminate it.

I. The Strict Legal Definition of Terrorism

The FBI definition of terrorism is precise and clinical: **The unlawful use of force or violence against persons or property to intimidate or coerce a government, civilian population, or any segment thereof, in furtherance of political or social objectives.** Look closely at that definition. The FBI does not attach a national flag to terrorism. The FBI does not attach a religion to terrorism.

When Americans see violence in the Middle East, they often attempt to redefine terrorism to fit their own biases. Let this Command be absolutely clear: **Islam is not terrorism.** Terrorism is an operational tactic, not a theology. When we wage the Global War on Terrorism, we are not waging war against a religion; we are hunting an operational behavior that uses violence to subjugate a population.

II. The Domestic Terrorists: Cartels and Traffickers

If we apply the FBI's definition accurately, the battlefield expands directly into our own cities. We must stop viewing domestic predators merely as "criminals" and recognize them for what they legally are: Terrorists.

- **Human Trafficking (Pimps):** A pimp uses physical violence, psychological torture, and intimidation to coerce a specific population (vulnerable women and children) to further a socio-economic objective. By the strict FBI definition, they are using force to coerce a segment of the civilian population for social gain. They are domestic terrorists.
- **Narcotics Syndicates (Drug Dealers/Cartels):** Drug dealers use lethal violence, turf wars, and the threat of execution to force populations to sell drugs and to maintain monopolies for socio-economic gain. Extortion, kidnapping, and aggravated assault are their primary weapons to coerce the civilian populace. They are domestic terrorists.

Any individual or syndicate that utilizes violence to force compliance, strip human autonomy, and achieve socio-economic dominance is an active combatant in the Global War on Terrorism.

III. The Righteous Movement: Slaying Evil

The congregation must lead a Righteous Movement to encourage world populations to eliminate these global and domestic threats.

This is not a new concept. The ancient Torah established the baseline protocol for handling absolute, unrepentant evil. The command regarding the Amalekites—a society defined by unprovoked cruelty and violence against the weak—was to completely eradicate the threat from the earth **(Deuteronomy 25:17-19)**. The biblical mandate is to *"extirpate the evil from your midst"* **(Deuteronomy 13:5)**.

While ancient authorities used systems like inquisitions to root out what they believed was "spiritual contagion" threatening the community, our modern, lawful mandate is to root out the physical contagion of terrorism. The Torah argues against negotiating with or showing mercy to those who delight in cruelty, because tolerating a predator only ensures the slaughter of the innocent.

IV. Operational Conclusion

The movement to lawfully eliminate ANY criminal whose actions fulfill the definition of terrorism is the ONLY solution to global and domestic instability.
We must support our law enforcement, our federal agencies, and our military in neutralizing these threats. If a man uses violence to coerce the innocent for his own gain, he is a terrorist. Whether he is hiding in a cave overseas, running a cartel across the border, or trafficking women on the streets of Seattle, the designation remains the same. The Vanguard does not negotiate with terrorists. We execute the law, we protect the innocent, and we slay the evil in our midst.

Hold the line. Eradicate the threat.

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